

Email Threat Intelligence & Forensic Report

Generated: 2026-08-27 12:36:34 UTC | Scan ID: scan_1643738ccc20 | File: phishing_ceo_fraud.eml

100/100
MALICIOUS

Executive Summary:

CRITICAL THREAT: This email exhibits multiple high-confidence indicators of phishing, domain spoofing, or malware delivery. Do not open attachments or click links.

1. Header & Identity Metadata

Subject:	URGENT: Immediate Action Required - Confidential Acquisition Wire Transfer
From:	Apple Executive Office <tim.cook@apple-executive-support.xyz>
To:	victim@company.com
Date:	Thu, 27 Aug 2026 09:15:00 +0000
Return-Path:	bounce-handler@random-spammer-relay.xyz
Originating IP:	185.220.101.5
Total Relay Hops:	1

2. Email Authentication Matrix

Protocol	Header Result	DNS Record Discovered
SPF (Sender Policy Framework)	FAIL	No published SPF TXT record
DKIM (DomainKeys Identified Mail)	FAIL	No DKIM signature found
DMARC (Domain-based Auth)	FAIL	No published DMARC record (_dmarc)

3. Explainable Risk Signals Triggered

Signal Name	Category	Severity	Weight	Description
SPF Authentication Softfail	AUTHENTICATION	MEDIUM	+15	The sending domain discourages this host from sending mail (~all policy).
DKIM Cryptographic Signature Invalid	AUTHENTICATION	HIGH	+25	DKIM signature check failed; email body or headers may have been modified in transit.
DMARC Policy Alignment Failed	AUTHENTICATION	CRITICAL	+30	Email failed DMARC validation against the sender domain's published security policy.
Header Domain Mismatch (From vs Return-Path/Reply-To)	SPOOFING	HIGH	+25	From domain (apple-executive-support.xyz) != Return-Path domain (random-spammer-relay.xyz); From domain (apple-executive-support.xyz) != Reply-To domain (darkweb-mail.top)

High IP Abuse Score (88%) on AbuseIPDB	THREAT_INTEL	CRITICAL	+35	The originating IP (185.220.101.5) has 142 recorded abuse reports for spam/malware/attacks.
Sender Domain Flagged Malicious on VirusTotal (9 engines)	THREAT_INTEL	CRITICAL	+40	Domain 'apple-executive-support.xyz' is identified as malicious by security vendors.
Raw IP Address Used in Hyperlink	CONTENT_ANALYSIS	HIGH	+20	Hyperlink points directly to an IP address instead of a legitimate registered domain name.
Deceptive Hyperlink Anchor Text	CONTENT_ANALYSIS	HIGH	+25	Visual anchor text shows one URL while the underlying hyperlink directs the user to a completely different domain.
Social Engineering & Urgency Indicators Detected	CONTENT_ANALYSIS	MEDIUM	+15	Trigger phrases detected: immediately action required, wire transfer
AI Intent Flag: CEO Fraud / Business Email Compromise (BEC)	AI_INTENT	HIGH	+20	The email exhibits traits of **CEO Fraud / Business Email Compromise (BEC)**. The attacker utilizes psychological manipulation strategies involving **Artificial Urgency, Financial Bait / Wire Request, Secrecy & Isolation** to pressure the recipient.

4. Threat Intelligence & IP Geolocation

Origin Location:	Brandenburg an der Havel, Brandenburg, Germany (DE)
ISP / Autonomous System:	Stiftung Erneuerbare Freiheit (AS60729 Stiftung Erneuerbare Freiheit)
Coordinates (Lat, Lon):	52.6171, 13.1207
AbuseIPDB Confidence:	88% (Reports: 142)
VirusTotal Domain Flag:	9 malicious / 90 engines (Reputation: -30)

5. Extracted Links & Defanged URL Forensics

Defanged Destination URL	Anchor Text	Security Flags
hxxp[://]185[.]220[.]101[.]5/apple-verify/login[.]php	https://secure.apple.com/corporate-acquisition-wire	• Raw IP address used as URL host (High Risk) • Mismatched anchor text: Visual 'https://secure.apple.com/corporate-acquisition-wire' differs from actual destination '185.220.101.5'